

c. 1953 May

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

another draft of previous letter to Rt. Rev. Edward J. Hickey

II

As much as I remember I had not seen either of them for some months. They had always come together. Now Miss Gibson comes alone with such unwanted tidings. More remarkable still however, though of a happier color is her story of a phenomena in connection therewith and which bring us nearer to our purpose. - - - our problem.

After her own recovery she - Miss G. - had taken a trip to New York, visiting friends and relatives as I understood - her own and those of Miss Daly - the deceased nurse-friend and naturally the latter's place of burial. This visit or visiting lasted for some days (five to be exact, as she tells me now). At all events, she brought back with a slip or sprig from a little "immortal" already growing on the still fresh grave where she had lingered these days and prayed and fostered supernatural hope. She had placed, the tiny sprig in a common envelope and when about / return / Detroit had placed it with some letters, etc, in her hand-bag. Some time afterwards, on opening the envelope she had been astonished at finding the slip, not only not withered and dried, not only fresh and green but actually having grown and in perfect bloom It is easy to speculate on the more than surprise that such a greeting offered the beholder That, for just now however, must be secondary. Suffice to say that her whole attitude was beaming. Her every move corroborated conviction. Spontaneously opening a small "vanity-box" to which her "relic" had been transferred, she like triumphantly displayed her "supernatural immortal." To me it was a marvel. To me it was a "blue-print" of what the nurses these late years had been dreaming about. - - - a sort of mystical fore-shadowing of how their yearnings to do something worthwhile for God and humanity were to be realized and their institution was to flourish, viz. quiet and unassuming, hidden-like from the unappreciative.

(Unfinished draft)